

ABNB independent thesis validation

14 September 2026 | Frozen September evidence | Research horizon: 3-12 months | Local review package

Retain the existing fixed kernel as a benchmark. An actionable guide-surprise or trading edge remains unestablished. The new early-origin forecast fails its preregistered hurdle. The correctly defined revenue gap is small, and the earnings-to-value result depends on unvalidated persistence and valuation assumptions.

Question	Evidence	Judgment
Before the release	Guide RMSE: kernel \$63.4m / \$63.7m ; direct guide-growth baseline \$74.3m / \$60.8m. Matched W1/W2 n=12/10. Year-removal stability also fails.	Forecast hurdle FAIL. Beats the revenue-growth baseline in both windows.
Expectations	L4 Q4 revenue \$3,179.344m versus captured LSEG-family revenue \$3,161.021m: +\$18.322m (+0.580%) . Own guide is \$3,123.419m.	Guide expectations unavailable. Comparing guide with revenue consensus cannot establish surprise.
Break-even	The LSEG revenue gap disappears with Q3 GBV -0.878% or Q4 conversion -0.0694pp , changing one input at a time.	Conditional boundaries, not probabilities. Physical cohort shares remain unidentified.
Economic size	A Q4-only gap gives about -\$0.001 to +\$0.031/share at 12 months with fixed SBC. Extending the same fraction through FY27 gives \$0.008-\$2.771/share.	Larger value requires unvalidated persistence. Cash-cost responses are scenarios.
Horizon and value	Using December 2027 balances prematurely adds \$1.80/share versus a conditional 12-month cash/share roll. One EBITDA multiple turn changes value by \$10.03/share .	No target adopted. These assumptions dominate the isolated revenue gap.

What survives and what remains unknown

The fixed conversion rule survives the earlier failed free-weight promotion test. Exact recognition shares, RNPL revenue leakage, future FX/hedge attribution and explicit guide expectations remain unidentified. Earlier executable-return evidence is inconclusive; the consensus-revision test failed. Source precision and correct accounting do not repair those missing links.

What would change the conclusion

Observe Q3 GBV and the first Q4 guide against dated expectations, then test whether any revenue difference persists into later quarters. Require disclosed costs, corporate cash, buyback execution and dilution to support the financial bridge. A guide-cushion change alone changes no actual earnings or cash. The planned November catalyst date remains a project-calendar assumption.

Limits on permitted use

This is a frozen-panel historical reconstruction, not an archived forecast record or untouched holdout. Origins are quarter start minus 18 days, rolled to a US session close. W1 spans 2023Q1-2026Q2; nested W2 spans 2024Q1-2026Q2. W1 has two abstentions. Midpoint +/- \$0.5m is a scoring convention; raw errors give the same verdict. Scenarios carry no calibrated probabilities. No current-price recommendation, production replacement or trade adoption follows.

Sources: prospective_v1/results_v1 (first-guide test); expectations_v2 (LSEG-family capture 13 Sep 2026 15:20 UTC); economics_v1/results_v2 (fixed SBC, cash-cost responses 0/0.5/1; conditional cash/share timing); accepted L3 bundle 8821961 and L4 baseline 29b2d9a. Exact commits, hashes, source limitations and independent review receipts accompany the handoff.